something we were accustomed to and it came as something of a rude jolt.

I realized that I needed to take my mind off cricket for a while, so I called Yuvi, Zaheer and Bhajji and suggested that we should watch a movie in the hotel room on reaching Kolkata for the third Test. I had already seen *Barfi!* – an award-winning film about a deaf mute – but it was so good that I really wanted to watch it again. Forty-five minutes into the film Bhajji said, '*Paaji yeh log kuch bolenge ki film aise hi chalta rahega?*' (Brother, are they going to say anything or is it going to continue in this silent vein for the whole movie?) Only Harbhajan could have come out with something like that!

After a string of failures, I decided to change my approach in the third Test in Kolkata, starting on 5 December 2012. I would stop being aggressive and instead play within myself, even though it was a really good batting pitch. Because of this defensive mind-set I missed out on a number of balls that in normal circumstances I would have put away for four, but I was mindful that I had done something similar in Australia in 2003–04 when I had scored a double hundred. This time I managed 76 before getting out to a good delivery from James Anderson straight after a drinks break. Anderson bowled beautifully throughout the series and was the central figure in the English attack. He used reverse swing well and picked up wickets at critical moments.

Yet again we had failed to make the most of our opportunities and we were all out for a modest 316. England were brilliant in response and Cook again led from the front with a spectacular 190. A skipper leading from the front is always good for a team and England put us under pressure again with a 207-run lead. Our second innings was nothing to write home about and I got out for five, caught at slip off Graeme Swann. None of the batsmen played to their potential and we lost the Test in four days.

We went to Nagpur for the last Test on 13 December 2012, needing a win to draw the series. Virat Kohli made a hundred and Dhoni was run out on 99, but my poor series continued as I was bowled by James Anderson for two in my only innings. It seemed that things were just not going my way and as I went into bat, I faced two balls from Monty Panesar that spun viciously. Till then the wicket had appeared flat and even the England players were surprised. That's what seems to happen when you're going through a bad patch. Trott made a hundred in